SSC CHSL 2019 Tier-I question paper with answers

19 October 2020 · Shift 2

49 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 51 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20210126081103/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerkeyCHSL2019T1_22012021.pdf

English Language (Basic Knowledge) 24 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Look before you leap

(A) Prepare yourself before jumping
(B) Caution others before taking a step
(C) Pull someone out from a disaster
(D) Think carefully of the consequences

Q.2

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. SACRED

(A) Profane
(B) Divine
(C) Solemn
(D) Pious

Q.3

Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence. Mother said to Kavya, "Switch off the light before you go to sleep."

(A) Mother told Kavya to switch off the light before you go to sleep.
(B) Mother told Kavya to switch off the light before she is going to sleep.
(C) Mother told Kavya to switch off the light before she goes to sleep.
(D) Mother told Kavya to switch off the light before she went to sleep.

Q.4

Select the word which means the same as the group of words given. A period of one thousand years

(A) Millennium
(B) Centenary
(C) Century
(D) Decade

Q.5

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Roman civilization emerged around the sixth century BC. At the height of (1)_____ power, the Roman Empire ruled over a huge chunk of (2)_____, and all the present-day Mediterranean countries (3)_____ part of ancient Rome. Early Rome was (4)_____ by kings, but later, the people took control over their own city and ruled (5)_____. They introduced a council known as the Senate which ruled over them. From this point, Rome was referred to as the Roman Republic.

Select the most appropriate option for blank number 1.

(A) its
(B) one’s
(C) his
(D) their

Q.6

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Roman civilization emerged around the sixth century BC. At the height of (1)_____ power, the Roman Empire ruled over a huge chunk of (2)_____, and all the present-day Mediterranean countries (3)_____ part of ancient Rome. Early Rome was (4)_____ by kings, but later, the people took control over their own city and ruled (5)_____. They introduced a council known as the Senate which ruled over them. From this point, Rome was referred to as the Roman Republic.

Select the most appropriate option for blank number 2.

(A) sea
(B) islands
(C) land
(D) country

Q.7

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Roman civilization emerged around the sixth century BC. At the height of (1)_____ power, the Roman Empire ruled over a huge chunk of (2)_____, and all the present-day Mediterranean countries (3)_____ part of ancient Rome. Early Rome was (4)_____ by kings, but later, the people took control over their own city and ruled (5)_____. They introduced a council known as the Senate which ruled over them. From this point, Rome was referred to as the Roman Republic.

Select the most appropriate option for blank number 3.

(A) have
(B) had
(C) are
(D) were

Q.8

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Roman civilization emerged around the sixth century BC. At the height of (1)_____ power, the Roman Empire ruled over a huge chunk of (2)_____, and all the present-day Mediterranean countries (3)_____ part of ancient Rome. Early Rome was (4)_____ by kings, but later, the people took control over their own city and ruled (5)_____. They introduced a council known as the Senate which ruled over them. From this point, Rome was referred to as the Roman Republic.

Select the most appropriate option for blank number 4.

(A) conducted
(B) governed
(C) controlled
(D) regulated

Q.9

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Roman civilization emerged around the sixth century BC. At the height of (1)_____ power, the Roman Empire ruled over a huge chunk of (2)_____, and all the present-day Mediterranean countries (3)_____ part of ancient Rome. Early Rome was (4)_____ by kings, but later, the people took control over their own city and ruled (5)_____. They introduced a council known as the Senate which ruled over them. From this point, Rome was referred to as the Roman Republic.

Select the most appropriate option for blank number 5.

(A) yourself
(B) themselves
(C) himself
(D) ourselves

Q.10

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. PERISH

(A) Vanish
(B) Grow
(C) Wither
(D) Crumble

Q.11

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Out of the given options pick the one that gives their correct order. A. When he returned, there was more than just his dog waiting for him. B. A koala had joined the dog in the car's more comfortable climate. C. A winemaker in South Australia left his air-conditioned car open to help keep his dog cool in the heat. D. Although the human struggled a while to make the koala leave, it did leave his car eventually.

(A) BACD
(B) CABD
(C) BCDA
(D) CBAD

Q.12

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. The important _____ is where to arrange the funds from.

(A) issue
(B) view
(C) result
(D) solution

Q.13

In the given sentence, identify the segment which contains a grammatical error. All these boys have come to college without few knowledge of English.

(A) without few knowledge
(B) have come to college
(C) of English
(D) All these boys

Q.14

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. MOROSE

(A) Optimistic
(B) Friendly
(C) Sullen
(D) Cheerful

Q.15

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Tedious
(B) Rebelleous
(C) Advantageous
(D) Victorious

Q.16

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Out of the given options pick the one that gives their correct order. A. People in a small Chinese town were shocked to see a wild elephant wandering in their town. B. The elephant eventually left the town. C. Authorities followed the large mammal's every movement. D. But the locals will probably never forget this special visit.

(A) ABDC
(B) ACBD
(C) CABD
(D) BDAC

Q.17

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. Several villages in Kashmir have been _____ due to heavy snowfall.

(A) isolated
(B) engaged
(C) confined
(D) divided

Q.18

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No improvement'. The house has a garden in front, "is it?"

(A) hasn't it
(B) No improvement
(C) does it
(D) isn't it

Q.19

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No improvement'. Many attempts "has been made" to climb the Everest before Tenzing and Hillary succeeded.

(A) had been made
(B) have been made
(C) No improvement
(D) was made

Q.20

In the given sentence, identify the segment which contains a grammatical error. Everyone are asking for passes to the music festival at Nehru Park.

(A) at Nehru Park.
(B) Everyone are asking
(C) for passes
(D) to the music festival

Q.21

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. AFFLUENT

(A) Destitute
(B) Proficient
(C) Impoverished
(D) Wealthy

Q.23

Select the word which means the same as the group of words given. A plantation of grapes

(A) Nursery
(B) Vineyard
(C) Orchard
(D) Grove

Q.24

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Chill out

(A) To calm down
(B) To fight
(C) To be angry
(D) To be nervous

Q.25

Select the correct passive form of the given sentence. He spent a lot of money on movies.

(A) A lot of money had been spent by him on movies.
(B) A lot of money was being spent by him on movies.
(C) A lot of money was spent by him on movies.
(D) A lot of money is spent by him on movies.

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

On August 13, at what cost did the Dikom Tea Estate of Assam sell its 'Golden Butterfly' tea at the GTAC, auction centre?

(A) Rs 1,00,000 per kg
(B) Rs 50,000 per kg
(C) Rs 25,000 per kg
(D) Rs 75,000 per kg

Q.2

Which of these eminent personalities is the one to not receive the Bharat Ratna from the Honorable President in the year 2019?

(A) Pranab Mukherjee
(B) Nanaji Deshmukh
(C) Sachin Tendulkar
(D) Bhupendra Kumar Hazarika

Q.3

Where were the Khelo India Youth Games held between January 10-22, 2020?

(A) Bhubaneshwar
(B) Guwahati
(C) Nagpur
(D) New Delhi

Q.4

According to the Motor Vehicles (Amendment) Bill 2019, what is the proposed minimum compensation for hit and run case wherein, the victim die?

(A) 2,00,000
(B) 1,50,000
(C) 1,00,000
(D) 50,000

Q.5

What was the name of the mega-ocean that surrounded the single continental mass before the continental drift as described by Alfred Wegener?

(A) Panama
(B) Panthalassa
(C) Pigmalion
(D) Pangaea

Q.6

Which of the following ministries launched the two campaigns, named Angikaar and E-course?

(A) Ministry of Women and Child Development
(B) Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs
(C) Ministry of Human Resource and Development
(D) Ministry of Home Affairs

Q.7

Which environmental phenomenon has been linked to synthetic chemicals like chlorofluorocarbons (CFCs)?

(A) Electromagnetic interference
(B) Tidal flow
(C) Ozone depletion
(D) Wave propagation

Q.8

Above which layer of the atmosphere does the Exosphere lies?

(A) Stratosphere
(B) Thermosphere
(C) Mesosphere
(D) Troposphere

Q.9

Which of the following trees will you find in the Littoral forests?

(A) Chinar
(B) Ebony
(C) Sundari
(D) Cypress

Q.10

Who among the following is the 15th Chairman of the Finance Commission of India?

(A) Y. V. Reddy
(B) Vijay L. Kelkar
(C) C. Rangarajan
(D) N.K Singh

Q.11

In which year was the Harappan civilization first discovered?

(A) 1932
(B) 1905
(C) 1921
(D) 1926

Q.12

Which of the following Articles ensures to provide free and compulsory education to all children in the age group of six to fourteen years as a Fundamental Right to Education?

(A) 20A
(B) 14
(C) 18A
(D) 21A

Q.13

On January 6, 2020, how many Oman ships arrived at Goa to participate in “Naseem-Al-Bahr”, the Indo-Oman bilateral naval exercise?

(A) 4
(B) 2
(C) 1
(D) 3

Q.14

Which of the following teams did the India Under-15 team defeat with a 7-0 score in the final of the SAFF (South Asian Football Federation) U-15 Championship 2019 held at Kalyani Stadium, West Bengal?

(A) Sri Lanka
(B) Uzbekistan
(C) Turkmenistan
(D) Nepal

Q.15

What is the shortcut key for the central alignment of a line or text in MS Office software?

(A) Ctrl+E
(B) Ctrl+C
(C) Ctrl+G
(D) Ctrl+A

Q.16

Which of these is an excretory organ of the human body?

(A) Heart
(B) Skin
(C) Brain
(D) Muscles

Q.17

Which among the following states won the final of the 25th Senior Women's NFC 2019-20 at Arunachal Pradesh?

(A) Manipur
(B) Tamil Nadu
(C) Arunachal Pradesh
(D) Odisha

Q.18

On 7th January 2020, who among the following was the Chairman of the second National GST Conference and Central and State Commissioners that was held to streamline the Goods and Services Tax?

(A) Nirmala Sitharaman
(B) Anurag Thakur
(C) Amit Shah
(D) Ajay Bhushan Pandey

Q.19

Which of these is not an Operating System?

(A) Unix
(B) SQL
(C) Linux
(D) Mac OS

Q.20

In which state did the 'Saila' dance originate? The dance is performed by boys after the harvest season.

(A) Bihar
(B) Jharkhand
(C) Chhattisgarh
(D) Odisha

Q.21

Which of the following states will you go to enjoy the famous Gaura-Gauri Puja that is celebrated every year?

(A) Gujarat
(B) Chhattisgarh
(C) Rajasthan
(D) Uttarakhand

Q.22

Which of the following are the 5 groups that plants are divided into?

(A) Mollusca, Bryophytes, Pteridophytes, Gymnosperms and Angiosperms

(B) Thallophytes, Bryophytes, Pteridophytes, Gymnosperms and Angiosperms

(C) Arthropoda, Bryophytes, Pteridophytes, Gymnosperms and Angiosperms

(D) Annelida, Bryophytes, Pteridophytes, Gymnosperms and Angiosperms

Q.23

In which year was the Second Anglo-Mysore war fought between the Kingdom of Mysore and the British East India Company?

(A) 1785-1789

(B) 1769-1775

(C) 1766-1769

(D) 1780-1784

Q.24

In which of the following states of India is the Bomdi-La Pass located?

(A) Sikkim

(B) Arunachal Pradesh

(C) Assam

(D) Himachal Pradesh

Q.25

In which year was the Dronacharya Award instituted?

(A) 1978

(B) 1985

(C) 1997

(D) 1991

Answer key

English Language (Basic Knowledge)

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(A)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(A)**	Q.25 **(C)**

General Awareness

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(B)**					

Explanations

English Language (Basic Knowledge)

Q.1 · Answer (D) Think carefully of the consequences

'Look before you leap' means think carefully about what may follow before you act.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Profane

'Sacred' means holy; 'profane' means not holy, or showing disrespect for holy things. 'Divine', 'solemn' and 'pious' are close to 'sacred'.

Q.3 · Answer (D) Mother told Kavya to switch off the light before she went to sleep.

SSC's key gives 'before she went to sleep': with a past reporting verb the command becomes 'told Kavya to switch off', 'you' becomes 'she' and the present 'go' shifts back to 'went'. 'Before she goes to sleep' is also heard when the bedtime is still to come, but the textbook rule is the backshift.

Q.4 · Answer (A) Millennium

A millennium is a thousand years. A century is a hundred years, a decade ten, and a centenary the hundredth anniversary of something.

Q.5 · Answer (A) its

The pronoun refers to 'the Roman Empire', a singular thing: 'at the height of its power'.

Q.6 · Answer (C) land

An empire rules over territory: 'a huge chunk of land'.

Q.7 · Answer (D) were

The passage is about ancient Rome, so the verb is past, and plural to agree with 'countries': 'were part of ancient Rome'.

Q.8 · Answer (B) governed

A state is 'governed' by its rulers: 'Early Rome was governed by kings', which the next clause contrasts with the people ruling their own city.

Q.9 · Answer (B) themselves

The reflexive pronoun must match 'the people', which is plural: they 'ruled themselves'.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Grow

To 'perish' is to die or come to an end; to 'grow' is to live and develop. 'Vanish', 'wither' and 'crumble' are close to 'perish'.

Q.11 · Answer (B) CABD

C says the winemaker left his car open for his dog; A says he came back to find more than his dog; B says a koala had got in; D says it left only after a struggle: CABD.

Q.12 · Answer (A) issue

An 'issue' is a matter to be decided, which is what the question of where to find the funds is.

Q.13 · Answer (A) without few knowledge

'Few' goes with countable nouns; 'knowledge' is uncountable, so it should be 'without much knowledge' (or 'with little knowledge').

Q.14 · Answer (C) Sullen

'Morose' means gloomy and bad-tempered: 'sullen'. 'Optimistic', 'friendly' and 'cheerful' are nearly opposite.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Rebelleous

'Rebelleous' is misspelt: the word is 'rebellious'.

Q.16 · Answer (B) ACBD

A introduces the elephant in the town; C says the authorities followed its every move; B says it finally left; D, opening with 'But', closes on the locals' memory of the visit: ACBD.

Q.17 · Answer (A) isolated
Villages cut off from everywhere else by heavy snow are 'isolated'.

Q.18 · Answer (A) hasn't it
A positive statement takes a negative tag built on its own verb, and 'is' does not match 'has': 'The house has a garden in front, hasn't it?'

Q.19 · Answer (A) had been made
The attempts came before another past event, Tenzing and Hillary's success, so the past perfect is needed, which also suits the plural 'attempts': 'had been made'.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Everyone are asking
'Everyone' takes a singular verb: 'Everyone is asking for passes ...'.

Q.21 · Answer (D) Wealthy
'Affluent' means rich: 'wealthy'. 'Destitute' and 'impoverished' are its opposites, and 'proficient' means skilled.

Q.23 · Answer (B) Vineyard
A vineyard is a plantation of grapevines. An orchard grows fruit trees, a grove is a small group of trees, and a nursery raises young plants.

Q.24 · Answer (A) To calm down
To 'chill out' is to calm down and relax.

Q.25 · Answer (C) A lot of money was spent by him on movies.
The simple past 'spent' becomes 'was spent' with the singular subject 'a lot of money': 'A lot of money was spent by him on movies.'

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (D) Rs 75,000 per kg
On 13 August 2019 a kilogram of the Dikom Tea Estate's 'Golden Butterfly' tea, made from buds, sold for ₹75,000 at the Guwahati Tea Auction Centre, a record price at the time.

Q.2 · Answer (C) Sachin Tendulkar
Pranab Mukherjee, Nanaji Deshmukh and Bhupen Hazarika (the last two posthumously) received the Bharat Ratna from President Ram Nath Kovind in August 2019. Sachin Tendulkar received it in 2014.

Q.3 · Answer (B) Guwahati
The third Khelo India Youth Games were held in Guwahati, Assam, from 10 to 22 January 2020.

Q.4 · Answer (A) 2,00,000
The Motor Vehicles (Amendment) Bill, 2019 raised the compensation for a death in a hit-and-run case from ₹25,000 to ₹2,00,000.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Panthalassa
Wegener called the single supercontinent Pangaea and the vast ocean around it Panthalassa.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs
The Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs launched, in August 2019, the Angikaar campaign for beneficiaries of the Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana (Urban) and an e-course on the Vulnerability Atlas of India.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Ozone depletion
Chlorofluorocarbons release chlorine in the stratosphere, which breaks down ozone; the Montreal Protocol was agreed to phase them out.

Q.8 · Answer (B) Thermosphere
The exosphere, the outermost layer, lies above the thermosphere. Going up, the layers are the troposphere, stratosphere, mesosphere, thermosphere and exosphere.

Q.9 · Answer (C) Sundari
Littoral (swamp) forests are the mangroves of coasts and deltas; the sundari tree, after which the Sundarbans are named, is typical of them.

Q.10 · Answer (D) N.K Singh
N. K. Singh chaired the Fifteenth Finance Commission, set up in November 2017. Y. V. Reddy chaired the Fourteenth, Vijay Kelkar the Thirteenth and C. Rangarajan the Twelfth.

Q.11 · Answer (C) 1921
Daya Ram Sahni's excavations at Harappa in 1921 first brought the civilisation to light; Mohenjo-daro followed in 1922.

Q.12 · Answer (D) 21A
Article 21A, added by the 86th Amendment (2002), makes free and compulsory education for children aged six to fourteen a Fundamental Right.

Q.13 · Answer (B) 2
Two Royal Navy of Oman ships, Al Rasikh and Khassab, came to Mormugao, Goa, in January 2020 for the 12th edition of Naseem-Al-Bahr.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Nepal
India beat Nepal 7-0 in the final at Kalyani to win the 2019 SAFF U-15 Championship. Uzbekistan and Turkmenistan are not SAFF members.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Ctrl+E
Ctrl+E centres the selected text in Word and PowerPoint. Ctrl+C copies, Ctrl+A selects all and Ctrl+G opens Go To.

Q.16 · Answer (B) Skin
The skin removes water, salts and a little urea in sweat, so it counts among the excretory organs, with the kidneys, lungs and liver.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Manipur
Manipur beat Railways 1-0 in the final at Pasighat, Arunachal Pradesh, in September 2019 to keep the title, its 20th Senior Women's National Football Championship.

Q.18 · Answer (D) Ajay Bhushan Pandey
Revenue Secretary Ajay Bhushan Pandey chaired the second National GST Conference of Central and State Tax Commissioners in New Delhi on 7 January 2020.

Q.19 · Answer (B) SQL
SQL (Structured Query Language) is a language for working with databases. Unix, Linux and Mac OS are operating systems.

Q.20 · Answer (C) Chhattisgarh
Saila, a stick dance performed by young boys after the harvest, is a folk dance of Chhattisgarh.

Q.21 · Answer (B) Chhattisgarh
Gaura-Gauri Puja, the worship of Shiva (Gaura) and Parvati (Gauri) at Diwali time, is a festival of Chhattisgarh.

Q.22 · Answer (B) Thallophytes, Bryophytes, Pteridophytes, Gymnosperms and Angiosperms
Plants are grouped as thallophytes, bryophytes, pteridophytes, gymnosperms and angiosperms. Mollusca, Arthropoda and Annelida are animal phyla.

Q.23 · Answer (D) 1780-1784
The Second Anglo-Mysore War (1780-1784), fought by Hyder Ali and then Tipu Sultan, ended with the Treaty of Mangalore.

Q.24 · Answer (B) Arunachal Pradesh
Bomdi La is a pass in the West Kameng district of Arunachal Pradesh.

Q.25 · Answer (B) 1985

The Dronacharya Award, for outstanding sports coaches, was instituted in 1985.

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